81 *Make*, *do* and *take*: uses and phrases

A Things we *make*, *do* and *take*

Common mistakes

We use all three of these common verbs with particular nouns. These word partners (collocations) are often different in other languages, so look at them carefully.

I've **made** a **mistake**.
She **took** a **photo** of me this morning.
They **made** a big **effort** to finish the work.

I'm afraid I haven't **done** my **homework**.
I haven't **done** the **housework** yet.
The children are **making** too much **noise**.

Sometimes two different verbs are possible.
I'm just going to **take/have** a **shower**.
Take/Have a look at these pictures.
We must **make/take** a **decision**.

I'm **doing/taking** a Spanish **course** next month.
I don't **do/take** much **exercise**.

B *Make*

Make can mean 'to cause something to happen or cause a particular state'**.**
I like Boris – he **makes me** laugh.
It **made them** angry when Karen refused to help with the washing-up.
Make can also mean 'to force someone to do something'.
My parents **made me** do my homework when I was a child.
The police **made us** wait outside the main gates.

If you **make friends with** someone, you get to know them and like them.
I **made friends with** a couple of guys from Canada when I was on holiday.
If you **make up your mind,** you decide something.
He's **made up his mind** to leave work at the end of next month.

C *Do*

We use **do** to describe a general action when we don't know what it is, or there's no noun.
What shall we **do** this afternoon?
Don't just stand there, **do** something.

If you **do your hair** / **make-up**, you make it look nice.
I'll just **do my hair**, then we can go out.

If you **do your best,** you try as hard as possible.
I'm not a good student, but I always **do my best**.

D *Take*

Take can mean to:

- remove something from a place/person, e.g. I **took** the key **out of** my pocket.
- remove something without permission, e.g. Someone has **taken** my pen.
- accept something, e.g. Did he **take** the job they offered him? Do they **take** credit cards there?
- write something down, e.g. I **took** notes during the meeting. The man **took** my name and address.
- wear a particular size in clothes, e.g. I **take** size 43 shoes.

If you **take it** / **things easy**, you relax and don't do very much.
I'll **take things easy** today.

If you **take a break**, you stop work and rest for a short period.
Let's **take a** ten-minute **break**.

Exercises

81.1 Choose the correct verb(s). Sometimes both are correct.

1 Did he *do / make* many mistakes?
2 I couldn't *do / make* the homework.
3 We must *take / make* a decision soon.
4 I want to *do / make* a course in English.
5 Could you *take / have* a look at this letter?
6 How many photos did they *make / take*?
7 I don't often *make / do* the housework.
8 They *did / made* a lot of noise at the party.

81.2 What are the people doing in the pictures?





1 *She's taking a photo.*
3 .....
5 .....





2 .....
4 .....
6 .....

81.3 Replace the underlined word or phrase with a phrase including the verb in capitals. Keep a similar meaning.

1 I <u>clean the flat</u> at the weekend. DO
2 They <u>forced us to go</u>. MAKE
3 I'm <u>trying as hard as possible</u>. DO
4 OK, let's <u>stop work and relax</u> for a bit. TAKE
5 He is definitely <u>trying</u>. MAKE
6 When are they going to <u>decide</u>? MAKE
7 I'm going to <u>relax and do nothing</u> this weekend. TAKE

I do the housework at the weekend.
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

81.4 Complete the sentences.

1 Someone *took* ..... my coat. It was here a minute ago and now it's gone.
2 I'm tired of writing this report. I'm going to ..... a break for ten minutes.
3 We ..... friends with Andrés when we were in the same class last year.
4 I've ..... nothing today.
5 If they offered him a job with more money, why didn't he ..... it?
6 Could you take a ..... at my essay? I think there are lots of mistakes in it.
7 When he shouted out the wrong answer, it ..... him look stupid.
8 What size do you ..... ?
9 I'm putting on weight because I don't ..... enough exercise.
10 I've ..... up my mind. I'm going to go to Thailand for my holiday.

81.5 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

1 What things make you happy, make you sad, and make you angry?

2 What things do your parents, or your boss, or your teachers make you do (or made you do in the past)?

82 Key verbs: *give*, *keep* and *miss*

A *Give*

We can use **give** when someone or something causes a certain effect.

All that noise has **given me a headache**.
The walk this morning **gave me an appetite** [made me hungry].
Listening to Wai Sin has **given me an idea**.

We often use **give** with different nouns to express an action.

He **gave** me some **advice** [advised me].
Valentina **gave** us a **shock** when she shouted like that. [shocked us]
I had to **give** a **speech** at the wedding. [talk formally to a group of people; also **give a lecture**]
I'll **give** her a **ring** [ring/phone her].
I had lots of work to do, but fortunately Ollie **gave** me **a hand** [helped me].



She **gave** me a **hug**.



He **gave** the car a **push**.

B *Keep*

Keep can mean to stay or cause someone to stay in a particular state or condition.

Keep right [stay on the right side].
This coat will **keep you warm**.
She asked us to **keep quiet**.
Going to the gym **keeps me fit**.

Keep (**on**) **doing something** means to repeat doing something, and often it is something you don't want to do or happen.

I **keep losing** my glasses.
I **keep getting** backache.
She **keeps on interrupting** me. [talks to me / disturbs me when I am doing something]

If you **keep in touch,** you continue to communicate with someone, especially by phone or email.
I met Mara on holiday and we've **kept in touch** ever since.
If you **keep a secret**, you don't tell other people something that you know.
Tom told me not to tell anyone about his new job, but I'm not very good at **keeping a secret**.
If you **keep something up**, you continue doing something at a high level.
You're working hard and your English is improving. That's good – **keep it up**.

C *Miss*

If you **miss** a person, you feel sad because that person is not there.
When I went to work in Hungary, I really **missed my girlfriend**.
If you **miss** what someone says, you don't hear it.
I'm sorry, I **missed that**. What did you say?
If you **miss a chance** / **opportunity**, you don't use an opportunity to do something.
Lily's been chosen for the team, but now she's injured, she might **miss her chance** to play.
If you **miss** something, you manage to avoid it or not experience it.
I left home early in order to **miss the rush hour**.

Exercises

82.1 Match each verb with three phrases on the right.

give	*a speech*	in touch
		~~a speech~~
		an opportunity
miss		on doing something
		someone a hug
		a person
keep		someone a hand
		what someone says
		a secret

82.2 Complete the sentences with a suitable adjective or *-ing* form.

1 I never drink coffee at night; it keeps me *awake* .
2 This umbrella should keep you ..... .
3 I don't know why she keeps ..... – it wasn't a very funny story.
4 If you do lots of exercise, it'll keep you ..... .
5 It's really stupid, but I keep ..... to lock the doors and windows when I go out.
6 They're making a lot of noise in there. Could you tell them to keep ..... ?
7 I know his name is Stuart, but I keep ..... it's Stephen.
8 I keep ..... up early in the morning because it's so light in my bedroom.

82.3 Complete the dialogues using a verb + noun. Don't repeat the underlined phrases.

1 A: He's <u>sad without Harper</u>.
B: I know. He *misses her* .
2 A: Did you <u>phone</u> her?
B: Yes, I ..... her a ..... last night.
3 A: He didn't <u>put his arms round her</u>, did he?
B: Yes. He ..... her a big ..... .
4 A: Have you <u>stayed in contact</u> with your old school friends all this time?
B: Yes, I've tried to ..... in ..... as much as possible.
5 A: Could anyone <u>help me</u> with this?
B: Yeah, I'll ..... you a ..... .
6 A: It's his own fault. He <u>had a chance to go and he didn't take it</u>.
B: I know. He ..... his ..... .
7 A: I expect <u>you're hungry</u> after all that work.
B: Yes, it's ..... me an ..... .

82.4 Complete the sentences with the correct verb and a word from the box.

~~shock~~	fun	headaches	secret	push	up	dog	idea	rush hour

1 She *gave* me a *shock* when she broke that window.
2 If we leave the party early, we'll ..... all the ..... .
3 The guys are working really hard, but I don't know if they can ..... it ..... .
4 I couldn't get the car started, but fortunately someone ..... me a ..... .
5 We left before seven because we wanted to ..... the ..... .
6 She doesn't know what the problem is, but she ..... getting ..... .
7 I saw a fascinating programme on TV, and that's what ..... me the ..... .
8 When I go on holiday alone, I really ..... my ..... .
9 I didn't say anything to Annie about the wedding because she can't ..... a ..... .

83 *Get*: uses, phrases and phrasal verbs

A Uses

Get is an informal word and is very common in spoken English. It can have many different meanings.

OBTAIN	I **got** a ticket from my brother.	I need to **get** some help.
RECEIVE	I **got** a new phone for my birthday.	Did you **get** my email?
BUY	Where did you **get** that watch?	I went to **get** a magazine.
ARRIVE	What time did you **get** here?	I'll phone when I **get** home.
BECOME	It **gets** dark very early in winter.	My hands are **getting** cold.
FETCH ⟷	Could you (**go and**) **get** my glasses from the kitchen for me?	
ANSWER the door/phone	A: Is that the door?	B: Yes, I'll **get** it.



DO a task, or arrange for someone to do it for you, using get + past participle

I'll never **get** this essay finished; it's too difficult.
I need to **get** my hair cut.
I **got** my watch repaired today.

B Phrases

You can **get in touch with** me via email. [make contact by email, phone or letter]
A bedtime story helps children **get to sleep** [start sleeping].
The salsa classes are a chance for us to **get together** [meet and spend time together].
I'm sorry I **got** the number **wrong** [said or wrote something that was not correct].
My cold is **getting worse** [becoming more unpleasant; *opp* **getting better**].
I'd like to **get rid of** my old CDs. [throw them away, give them away, or sell them]
I **got to know** lots of Americans when I stayed in San Francisco. [met and became friends with]

C Phrasal verbs

He stopped the car and I **got out** [left the car; also leave a building].
I gave her £25, but I'll **get** it **back** tomorrow. [have it returned to me]
The door was locked so we couldn't **get in** [enter a place, especially when it is difficult].
Our train should **get in** around midnight. [arrive]
What time did you **get up** this morning? [get out of bed]

Exercises

83.1 **Write a synonym for *get* in each of these sentences.**

1 I usually get about five emails a day. *receive*
2 Where can I get something to eat round here? .....
3 I'm just going to get some paper from the office. I'll be back in a minute. .....
4 What time did they get here last night? .....
5 He got very angry when I told him what you did with his CDs. .....
6 I couldn't get a room; all the hotels were full. .....
7 The phone's ringing. Could you get it for me? .....
8 Molly sent me a card but I never got it. .....

83.2 **Complete the dialogues using *getting* + a suitable adjective. Add other words if necessary.**

1 A: It's *getting cold in here* .
B: Yes, it is. I'll turn on the heating.
2 A: I'm .....
B: Me too. Let's have something to eat.
3 A: I'm .....
B: Yes, me too. I'll open the window.
4 A: It's .....
B: Yes, it is. I'll put the lights on.
5 A: It's .....
B: Yes, it is. I think I'll go to bed.
6 A: My English is .....
B: No, it isn't – it's much better now.

83.3 **Rewrite the sentences using a phrase or phrasal verb with *get*. Keep a similar meaning.**

1 Will the books be returned to you?
Will you *get the books back?*
2 We must meet up and have a meal.
We must .....
3 How do you meet people and make friends in this country?
How do you .....
4 I must contact the travel company.
I must .....
5 I'd like to throw away these old magazines.
I'd like to .....
6 The train won't arrive before 10 o'clock.
The train won't .....
7 The doors were locked; we couldn't leave.
The doors were locked; we couldn't .....
8 I was awake for hours last night.
I couldn't .....

83.4 **Continue these statements in a suitable way.**

1 The window is broken. We *need to get it repaired.*
2 My hair is getting long. I .....
3 This essay is taking me hours. I .....
4 My watch isn't working. I .....
5 Lola has still got my CDs. I .....

83.5 **Write down examples of *get* that you see or hear, and try to group your sentences according to the different meanings. This will help you to understand how this important word is used in English.**

84 *Go*: meanings and expressions

A Different meanings of *go*

- When we leave a place in order to do an activity, especially for enjoyment, we often express it with **go** + **-ing** or **go** (**out**) **for a** + noun.
  We could **go shopping** / **sightseeing** / **swimming** / **clubbing** [to a nightclub] tomorrow.
  Why don't we **go** (**out**) **for a walk** / **drive** / **drink** / **meal** / **picnic** at lunchtime?
- **Go** can also describe a changing state (usually to a bad one) with certain adjectives.
  My dad's **going grey** [his hair is becoming grey] and my uncle is **going bald** [losing his hair].
  My grandmother is **going deaf** [deaf = cannot hear].
  Our 12-year-old dog is **going blind** [blind = cannot see].
  He'll **go mad** if you wear his jacket. [become very angry; *infml*]



going bald

- We use **go** when we want to ask/say if a road or form of transport takes you somewhere.
  Does this bus **go** to the National Gallery?
  I think this road **goes** through the village.
- **Go** can also mean 'disappear'.
  When I looked in the drawer, my watch **had gone** [it was there before, but not now].
- **Go and get** means **fetch** [go to a place and bring something back with you].
  You stay here, and I'll **go and get** the bags from the car.

B Phrasal verbs and expressions

A: What's **going on** in here? [happening]

B: I don't know. I touched this switch and the lights **went out** [stopped working].

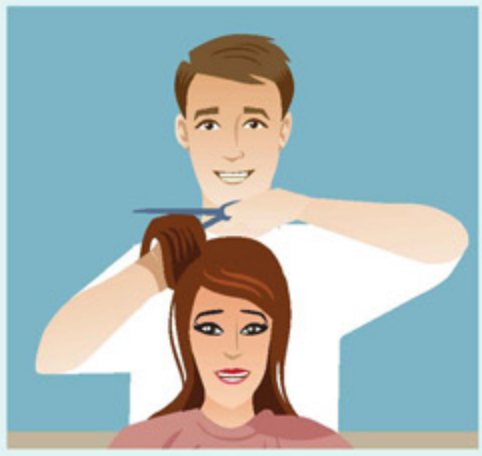
A: Shall we wait for George or **go on to** the theatre? [continue or move to another place/thing]

B: Er, I'm not sure of the way; let's wait for George.

A: How's the business?

B: Well, it was **going well** [successful; *opp* **going badly**] up until the summer, but since then a few things have **gone wrong** [there have been problems], and we've lost a few customers.

A: Are you **going away** this year? [going on holiday]



B: Yes. We had a lovely time in Italy last year, so we've decided to **go back** in June. [return]

A: I think I'll have the chicken. How about you?

B: I'm **going for** the roast beef. [choosing]

A: **How's it going?** [How are you? *infml*]

B: Not bad. And you?

Exercises

84.1 Complete the sentences with an *-ing* noun, e.g. riding, or *(out) for a* + noun, e.g. (out) for a walk.

1 I went *shopping* this morning and bought some new clothes.
2 It was a lovely day, so we made some sandwiches and decided to go _____.
3 Why don't we go _____ in that nice new café near the square?
4 I wanted to go _____ because it was my first time in Rome.
5 My brother has just got a new sports car. We could go _____ at the weekend.
6 The pool is at the end of the road, so we often go _____.
7 I'm just going to take the dog _____.
8 We went _____ last night and didn't get home until three this morning.
9 It was my father's birthday, so we decided to go _____.

84.2 Replace the underlined words with a different word or phrase. Keep a similar meaning.

1 He went mad when he saw me. *got angry*
2 Hi Sue. How's it going? _____
3 Could you go and get my handbag from the other room? _____
4 Do you want to go on and do the next exercise? _____
5 What's going on in the next classroom? _____
6 When I got back, the others had gone. _____
7 I can't stay for the weekend; I have to go back on Friday. _____
8 Excuse me. Does this road go to the bus station? _____
9 My girlfriend had fish but I went for the chicken dish. _____

84.3 Complete the dialogues with a phrasal verb or expression using *go*.

1 A: I hear you had problems with your exam?
B: Yes, everything *went wrong* . I couldn't answer any of the questions.
2 A: Can't he see very well?
B: No, I'm afraid he's _____.
3 A: Your uncle's just opened a new restaurant, hasn't he? How's it doing?
B: Great. It's _____.
4 A: I imagine your parents were angry that you had a party when they were away.
B: They were. My dad _____.
5 A: Simon isn't losing his hair already, is he?
B: Yes, I'm afraid he's _____.
6 A: Are the books downstairs in the staffroom?
B: Yes. Could you _____ them for me?
A: Yeah, sure.
7 A: Are you having a holiday this year?
B: Yes, we're hoping to _____ in the summer.
8 A: What have you done?!
B: I don't know. The lights just _____.

84.4 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

Do you often go swimming in the summer?
Do you go clubbing most weekends?
Do you often go shopping with a friend?
Did you often go for picnics as a child?
Do you often go for a walk on your own?
Do you like going out for a meal?
Do you often go sightseeing on holiday?
Do you enjoy going out for a drive in the country?

85 The senses

A The five basic senses



sight **hearing** **taste** **smell** **touch**

To express it another way, the ability to see, hear, taste, smell and feel.

B Sense verbs with adjectives

You **look** tired this evening. [from what I can see]
That man **sounded foreign**. [from another country, from what I could hear]
This cake **tastes** a bit strange.
Fresh bread **smells** wonderful.
This shirt **feels damp**. [slightly wet, often in an unpleasant way]

Language help

The verbs above can all be used as nouns.
*I like **the look of** this hotel*. [the appearance of it]
*I love **the sound of** his voice*.

C Sense verbs with *like* or *as if/though*

We can describe things using sense verbs with **like** + noun or **as if / though** + clause, but *not* **like** + adjective (NOT She looks ~~like~~ nice). When we use **like** + noun, we are often describing how similar two things are.

Have you ever had a nectarine? They **look like** peaches.
Did you hear that noise? It **sounded like** an alarm.
That shampoo **smells like** coconut. (also **smells of** coconut)
Don't you think this material **feels like** silk?



nectarine



alarm

That boy **looks as if** he's trying to get over the wall.
I spoke to Isobel. It **sounded as though** they had a good time on holiday.



coconut



silk

Language help

We also use **seem** and **appear** to describe a sense or feeling about someone or something, after we have seen them, talked to them, etc. Before **like** + noun, we usually use **seem**.
*I saw Will and he **seemed/appeared** quite happy.* *The shop **appears/seems** to be very busy.*
*Amelia said she wanted to travel a bit, which **seems like** a good idea.*

D Verbs easily confused

If you **look** [look carefully] at the map, you can **see** [are able to see] the church on the left.
They've been **watching** that man for weeks. [paying attention to something, often for a long time]
He ran into me because he wasn't **looking** [paying attention].
I **watched**/**saw** a film on TV. I **saw** a film at the cinema. (NOT I ~~watched~~ a film at the cinema.)
I **heard** [was able to hear] what she said but I wasn't **listening** [paying attention].
Don't **touch** the oven [put your hand on it]. It's hot!
Just **feel** my feet [put your hand on them to discover something about them]. Aren't they cold?

Exercises

85.1 **Cover the opposite page. What are the five basic senses?**

sight ....

85.2 **Choose the correct word to complete the sentences.**

1 I was very angry with Tom – he just wasn't *hearing* / *listening to* what I was saying.
2 I was *listening to* / *hearing* the radio when I *listened to* / *heard* a terrible noise outside.
3 She turned up the volume but I still couldn't *listen to* / *hear* it.
4 There's a good film on at the cinema. Have you *watched* / *seen* it?
5 Quick. Come and *watch* / *look at* this man walking by.
6 We *watched* / *looked at* the birds while they were eating food from the bird table.
7 If you stand near the fire, you can *touch* / *feel* how hot it is.
8 You mustn't *touch* / *feel* the paintings in the museum.
9 If you *see* / *look* carefully, you can *look* / *see* how the man does the magic trick.
10 Anya wants to get a parrot, which *seems* / *appears* like a strange thing to do.

85.3 **Complete the sentences with a different sense verb and a word from the box. Add *like* where necessary.**

~~delicious~~	a church	an alarm	very nice
damp	coconut	calm and relaxed	silk

1 Abigail has just taken the cakes out of the oven and they *smell delicious* .....
2 The sheets on her bed looked expensive, and when I touched them, they ..... .
3 I could see something quite tall in the distance. It ..... .
4 When I heard the noise I jumped out of bed because it ..... .
5 Have you tried these biscuits? They ..... .
6 I've just met my new class; they ..... .
7 I don't want to sit on the grass. It ..... .
8 I saw her before the exam and she ..... .

85.4 **Complete the middle part of the sentences.**

1 Alexei said that Lola was doing well, so it *sounds as if/though* ..... she'll pass the exam.
2 Erin told me about the accident. It ..... it was quite serious.
3 Put your hand on the radiator. Does it ..... it's getting warm?
4 I've just spoken to Tom. He ..... he's got a cold.
5 Have you tried the soup? It ..... it needs a bit more salt to me.
6 Is that your little boy on the floor? It ..... he's fallen over.
7 Alina didn't ask any questions. It ..... she wasn't interested.

85.5 Over to you

Complete the sentences about your own likes and dislikes. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

I love the smell of ..... .
I hate the smell of ..... .
I love the sound of ..... .
I hate the sound of ..... .
I love the taste of ..... .
I hate the taste of ..... .

86 Uncountable nouns

A Common uncountable nouns

One of the problems with uncountable nouns is that many of them are countable in other languages.

Common mistakes

I need information. (NOT I need ~~an~~ information.) (no indefinite article)
I need some information. (NOT I need ~~informations~~.) (no plural form)
The homework was difficult. (NOT The homework ~~were~~ difficult.) (use with a singular verb)

- You can put all that **rubbish** in the bin over there. [things that you throw away because you do not want them]
- Is there any more **news** about the man who was injured?
- She gave me some good **advice** about buying a car. [what you think someone should do]
- Do the children get **pocket money** [money that parents give regularly to their children]?
- You need a lot of **equipment** for camping, e.g. tent, sleeping bag, torch, things for cooking, etc. [the things that are used for a particular activity]
- We sold the **furniture** [tables, chairs, armchairs, etc.].
- The **scenery** is really beautiful. [the natural beauty you see around you]
- My **knowledge of** Russian is limited. [what I know about it]
- She's worked very hard and I believe she is **making progress** [improving / getting better].
- Can you take the dog? We haven't got any **room** in our car. [empty space]
- Would anyone like some more **toast**?
- The children's **behaviour** was terrible: they were climbing all over the furniture and making a lot of noise. [the way you do and say things]



bin

tent



sleeping bag



torch



toast



B Uncountable nouns in dictionaries

Dictionaries show countable nouns with a (C) and uncountable nouns with a (U). Some nouns can be countable with one meaning, and uncountable with another.

experience (U) [the knowledge you get from doing a particular job or activity]
She's got a lot of **experience of** working with children.
experience (C) [something that happens to you that affects the way you feel]
I had so many fantastic **experiences** on my trip to Thailand and Japan.

chance (U) [luck]
Lotto is a game of **chance**.
chance (C) [the opportunity to do something]
He's had several **chances** to go abroad, but he's just not interested.

C Making uncountable nouns countable

You can make some uncountable nouns singular. Sometimes we do this with a word like **piece** (for advice, equipment, toast, furniture, news), but in spoken English we often use **a bit** (*infml*) with most uncountable nouns.

a good **piece of** advice
another piece of toast
an interesting **bit of** news
just **a bit of** rubbish

Exercises

86.1 Correct the mistakes.

1 I need some ~~informations~~. *information*
2 Our teacher has a news about the trip. .....
3 She gave me some good advices. .....
4 Her progress are very good. .....
5 We had a lot of homeworks yesterday. .....
6 The furnitures were very old. .....
7 I have no experiences of using these equipments. .....
8 I need to improve my knowledges of this new technology. .....

86.2 Make the uncountable nouns countable.

1	I did some homework.	I did *a bit of homework.*
2	It's useful equipment.	It's .....
3	It was good advice.	It was .....
4	Do you want some more toast?	Do you want .....
5	She's making progress.	She's making .....
6	There's some rubbish on the floor.	There's .....
7	I gave them some pocket money.	I gave them .....
8	I heard some news this morning.	I heard .....

86.3 Complete the dialogues.

1 A: Have you been given all the details?
B: No, I need more *information* .
2 A: She hasn't worked there long enough.
B: No, she needs more ..... .
3 A: Is your flat big enough?
B: No, we need more ..... .
4 A: Does she know what to do when she leaves school?
B: No, she needs some ..... .
5 A: Don't you think the room looks empty?
B: Yes, we need more ..... .
6 A: Is his English getting better?
B: No, he isn't making any ..... .

86.4 Complete the sentences. The first letter has been given to help you.

1 I asked my teacher for some a*dvice* about grammar books.
2 I've had some great e..... when I've travelled on my own.
3 If we give him another c..... , I'm sure he'll be able to do it.
4 That stuff over there is r..... ; just throw it in the bin.
5 We camped on the hill above the lake because the s..... is so beautiful.
6 I don't know what's wrong with Celia, but her b..... was very strange this morning.
7 Do you have any e..... of working with computers?
8 I don't have any k..... of this subject; you'd better ask Fariah.

86.5 Use a dictionary to find out if these nouns are countable or uncountable. Keep a record of them in your notebook.

transport luggage suitcase pasta traffic accident

87 Verb constructions 1

A Verb + *-ing* form

A number of verbs are commonly followed by an *-ing* form.

QUESTIONNAIRE

QUESTIONS	ANSWERS
• Do you **enjoy** studying?	Yes, I do.
• Do you **mind** getting up early? [Is it OK for you, or not?]	No, I don't mind at all.
• Do you like or **dislike** having your photograph taken?	I **hate** having my picture taken.
• Do you usually **avoid** speaking to strangers at parties? [try not to do something]	Yes. I prefer to talk to people that I already know.
• Can you **imagine** being without a car? [think of yourself in a situation with no car]	No, I can't. I need my car.
• Have you ever **considered** [thought about] living in another country?	Yes, many times. I'd like to live abroad.
• Would you **recommend** [advise] having a holiday in the capital city of your country? If so, would you **suggest** going at a particular time of the year?	Yes, I would, and I would suggest going in spring or autumn.

Common mistakes

I enjoy going there. (NOT I enjoy ~~to go~~ there.) They suggested leaving early. (NOT They suggested ~~to leave~~ early.) He recommended staying there. (NOT He recommended ~~to stay~~ there.)

B Verb + *to* infinitive

I **hope** to see them next week. [want to see them and believe I will see them]
They **agreed** to help me. [said they will help]
I **intend** to leave next month. [plan]
I **offered** to help them. [said I was happy to help]
I **attempted** to cook the dinner, but it was terrible. [tried]
I **promised** to bring her book back. [said I would definitely bring it back]
The shop assistant was very rude, so I **demanded** to see the manager. [said in a firm way]

C Verb + (object) + preposition + noun/*-ing*

A: Jo has just rung and **asked** me **for** advice about Greece. They're **thinking of**[1] going there.

B: Well, be careful. They went to India last year on your advice and then **blamed**[2] you **for** the terrible holiday they had.

A: That was their fault. They **insisted on**[3] going in the summer when it was far too hot.

[1] thinking about going to Greece (often used in the continuous and followed by a noun/*-ing* form; NOT I'm thinking ~~to go~~ there.)
[2] said you were responsible for something bad, in this case the terrible holiday
[3] said they must go (in the summer)

Exercises

87.1 Choose the correct word(s) to complete the sentences.

1 I hope *seeing / to see* them.
2 They agreed *helping / to help* me.
3 We enjoy *staying / to stay* by the sea.
4 I suggested *going /to go* on the train.
5 She insisted *in / on* paying for our meal.
6 We must attempt *getting / to get* there on time.
7 Have you considered *working / to work* in a bank?
8 I demanded *speaking / to speak* to the doctor in charge.
9 I asked *him help / him for* help.
10 They blamed me *for / of* it.
11 I don't mind *waiting / to wait* for you.
12 I try to avoid *travelling / to travel* in the rush hour.

87.2 Complete the sentences with the most suitable verb.

1 Have you *asked* the waiter for the bill?
2 My sister is _____ of spending the summer in France if she can afford it.
3 I've had a computer for about 20 years; I can't _____ being without one.
4 We always try to _____ driving into town in the rush hour.
5 The accident wasn't my fault but they _____ me for it.
6 We're _____ to see my parents later this week. We had _____ to go last week, but Madison was ill and we couldn't go.
7 I _____ meeting your friends; they were really nice.
8 Have you ever _____ moving out of a town and going to live in the country?
9 I offered to drive, but Mason _____ on taking his car because he said he _____ being a passenger.
10 Ella's parents weren't happy with the school, and they _____ to see the head teacher.

87.3 When you learn new verbs, you may need to know the constructions that are used with them. A good dictionary will give you this information, usually with examples. Using a good English dictionary, find the constructions that commonly follow these verbs.

FORMAL
Might I suggest a white wine with your salmon, sir?
[+ (that)]
*I suggest **(that)** we wait a while before we make any firm decisions.*
*Liz suggested **(that)** I try the shop on Mill Road.*
[+ -ing VERB**]**
*I suggested putt**ing** the matter to the committee.*

fancy + _____ pretend + _____ or _____

decide + _____ or _____ accuse + _____

87.4 Over to you

Answer the questions in the questionnaire on the opposite page. If possible, ask someone else the same questions. Then complete the sentences about yourself using the correct construction after each verb.

I like _____
I dislike _____
I don't mind _____
I'm thinking _____
I can't imagine _____
I hope _____
I intend _____

88 Verb constructions 2

A

A great opportunity



"I'm 24 years old, and I work in a photography studio. It's not a very exciting job but I love photography and the pay isn't bad. But, two months ago, I was given the chance to go to Italy and work on a film by a famous director. My best friend thought that it was a fantastic opportunity and **advised**[1] **me to go**. Dad wasn't so sure. He didn't try and **persuade**[2] **me** not **to go**, but he **warned**[3] **me that** it would be hard work, and **reminded**[4] **me that** it was only three months, then I'd be out of a job. I **realised**[5] **that** my girlfriend wasn't happy about it either, but I **promised**[6] **her that** I would phone every day, and **suggested**[7] **that** she could come out to Italy for a holiday while I was there. I didn't **mention**[8] **that** I was part of a small team with three other women. Anyway, I'm going."

[1] say what you think someone should do — advise + obj + inf
[2] make someone agree to do something by talking a lot — persuade + obj + inf
[3] tell someone that something bad may happen, to stop it happening — warn + obj + (that) …
[4] tell someone something so that they don't forget it — remind + obj + (that) …
[5] understand something (that) you didn't understand before — realise + (that) …
[6] say (that) you will certainly do something — promise + (obj) + (that) …
[7] tell someone about a possible idea or plan — suggest + (that) …
[8] say something, often briefly or quickly — mention + (that) …

Language help

Some verbs can be followed by different constructions. We can also say, for example:

I suggested going there.	suggest + -ing
She warned me not to go.	warn + obj + inf
He reminded me to post the letter.	remind + obj + inf

B

Other verbs

Here are some more verbs which are used with the same constructions.

Verb + (***that***) …: *say, hope, notice, recommend* and *expect*.
I **said** that I was busy. (NOT I said ~~him~~ that I was busy.)
I **hope** (that) you'll come and see us soon.
When I left, I **noticed** that the door was open. [could see]
I **recommended** that we all go together, so no one gets lost.
I **expect** (that) he'll ring us later. [think or believe that something will happen]

Verb + object + (***that***) …: *tell, show* and *convince*.
I **told** them (that) they could leave early.
He tried to **convince me** that I needed some new clothes. [make me believe]

Verb + object + *to* infinitive: *ask, tell, want, allow, expect, remind, help* and *encourage*.
Tracey **asked** me to look after her cat.
They **told** us to wait outside.
They **want** us to stay at school.
I **expected** them to be here by now.
I had to **remind** him to buy the food. [tell somebody so that they do not forget]
She **helped** me to write the report. (You can also say: She helped me write the report.)
My parents **encouraged** me to read. [gave me support and confidence to make it possible]

Exercises

88.1 Correct the mistakes.

1 She encouraged me going. *She encouraged me to go.*
2 He told it's impossible. .....
3 I asked that Chloe stay with me. .....
4 She suggested us to go to an Italian restaurant. .....
5 I warned them not going. .....
6 He helped me buying my suit. .....
7 She allowed us go. .....
8 He said me the film was terrible. .....
9 She advised me buy a dictionary. .....
10 I recommended to stay there. .....
11 He reminded me go to the bank. .....
12 I want that he leaves. .....

88.2 Complete the sentences with a verb from the box in the correct form.

~~realise~~	warn	expect	remind	convince	encourage
help	persuade	mention	recommend	notice	hope

1 She couldn't breathe easily, so I *realised* that something was wrong.
2 When we went in, I ..... that people were looking at us.
3 Martin knew the area was dangerous but he didn't ..... me not to go there.
4 I didn't want the job but my mother ..... me to take it. It was a mistake.
5 I wasn't sure about the plan, but my boss ..... me that it would work.
6 My uncle ..... that we try the new Chinese restaurant.
7 When I spoke to Jodie, I ..... that we were busy tonight.
8 Our teacher has always ..... us to practise our English outside of class.
9 Fortunately Aidan ..... me that it was Marsha's birthday; I'd forgotten.
10 I said I would ..... Ian to put up the shelves.
11 They said they'd come, so I ..... that they'll be here soon.
12 I ..... that I pass my exams.

88.3 Complete the sentences in a suitable way.

1 He was given some money and I recommended *that he put it in the bank.*
2 Some of them were getting hungry so I suggested .....
3 She said there were strange noises outside her flat, so I advised .....
4 When I saw her face, I noticed .....
5 When I was young, my parents sometimes allowed .....
6 As soon as I put on the coat, I realised .....
7 It was only a few minutes to the beach, but I still couldn't persuade .....
8 Her train was delayed, so I expect .....
9 The water can make you ill and I warned .....
10 I borrowed his laptop yesterday but promised him that .....

88.4 Over to you

Look at the verbs on the opposite page again and translate them into your own language. Do you use the translated verbs with the same constructions? If not, these are the verbs that may cause you the most problems when you are speaking English.

89 Adjectives

A Extreme adjectives

There are many 'extreme' adjectives we use to say that something is very good, or very small, or very surprising, etc.

We were lucky – the weather was **marvellous** [very good; *syns* **terrific**, **wonderful**, **amazing**].
Don't go and see that film – it's **awful** [very bad; *syn* **dreadful**].
I was **delighted** she passed her exam. [very pleased]
It's a nice modern flat, but it's absolutely **tiny** [very small].





I wasn't very hungry, but they gave us a **huge** meal. [very big; *syn* **enormous**]
You should watch that programme; you'll find it absolutely **fascinating** [very interesting].
Everyone was really **exhausted** by the end of the day. [very tired]
Bungee jumping is the most **terrifying** thing I've ever done. [very frightening]
Computers are an **essential** part of modern life. [very important and necessary]
The food was **delicious** [very good; but usually only for food].

Language help

The food was **absolutely marvellous**. (NOT The food was ~~very marvellous~~.) We can use **absolutely** or **really** before extreme adjectives, e.g. *absolutely awful, really terrific*, but we can't use **very**.
We use **very** or **really** with gradable adjectives which do not have an extreme meaning, e.g. *very big, very good, very nice, very tired, really good, really tired*, etc. (NOT ~~absolutely big~~)

B Adjectives ending in *-ing* and *-ed*

A large group of adjectives can have an **-ing** or **-ed** ending. The **-ing** ending describes a person, thing or situation; the **-ed** ending describes the effect on someone of this person, thing or situation.

I don't know if other people were **bored**, but I thought it was a very **boring** lesson.
The weather is so **depressing** at the moment; it's making everyone feel **depressed**.

Common mistakes

I was bored by that film. (NOT I was ~~boring~~ by that film.)
We're very interested in the new designs. (NOT We're very ~~interesting~~ in the new designs.)

These adjectives can all end in **-ing** or **-ed**, depending on the meaning.

It was really **tiring** going up that hill. [making you feel tired]
I was **amazed** she could climb that wall. [very surprised]
My exam results were very **disappointing** [not as good as I expected].
She was **annoyed** that I forgot to tell her. [angry]
I kept calling her Emma, so I was **embarrassed** when Ben told me her name was Angela. [feeling a bit stupid because of something you have said or done]
The map he gave us was very **confusing** [difficult tounderstand].
We were **shocked** by the violence in the film. [very surprised in an unpleasant way]

Exercises

89.1 **Put the words into the correct column.**

~~bad~~	~~dreadful~~	important	small	exhausted
terrified	tired	essential	frightened	tiny

gradable adjectives	extreme adjectives
bad	*dreadful*

89.2 **Change the adjectives where possible to give the email a more positive and/or more extreme effect. Include *absolutely* or *really* two or three times.**

Reply Forward

From Benita S. x 4:35 PM (1 hour ago)

Dear Sandy

an (absolutely) exhausting

Arrived on Sunday evening after ~~a very tiring~~ journey. We're very pleased with the hotel: our room is very big, and the food is very nice. We've been lucky with the weather as well. The first day was wet but the last three days have been very nice.

Tomorrow we're going to walk the coastal path to Dartmouth Castle. It's quite a difficult route and people tell us it's very important to take a map, but it sounds very interesting, so I'm looking forward to it.

I'll write again in a couple of days and tell you all about it.

love

Benita

89.3 **Complete the dialogues so that B agrees with A, using a suitable adjective from the opposite page.**

1 A: I was very interested in her talk.
B: Yes, it was *fascinating* .
2 A: Were you very frightened?
B: Yes, it was absolutely ..... .
3 A: It was surprising to see the children behave so badly.
B: I know. We were ..... .
4 A: Did you have a nice holiday?
B: Yes, absolutely ..... .
5 A: I expect you were very pleased with your score.
B: Yes, I was absolutely ..... .
6 A: I expect you were a bit angry when they arrived an hour late?
B: Yes, I was very ..... .

89.4 **Write an adjective to describe how the people felt in these situations.**

1 They walked ten miles, then spent the afternoon cutting down trees. *exhausted*
2 From the description on the travel website, they expected a beautiful big villa by the sea. In actual fact it was quite small, not very nice, and miles from the beach. .....
3 I arrived in jeans, but everyone else was wearing very formal clothes. .....
4 One person told them the street was on the left, another told them to turn right, and a third person said they had to go back to the station. .....
5 My brother has a flat and it's usually in a terrible mess – he's very untidy. But yesterday when I visited him, the place was incredibly tidy. In fact, everything looked new. .....
6 I got my results yesterday and I passed every exam with a grade A. .....

90 Prepositions: place and movement

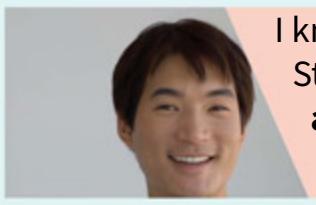
A *At*, *on* and *in*

At a point or place, e.g. I met her **at** the bus stop. He's **at** work at the moment.
On a surface, e.g. The book's **on** the desk. They sat **on** the floor. I put the picture **on** the wall.
In an area, space, or inside something, e.g. He's **in** the kitchen. She lives **in** Warsaw/Poland. The knife's **in** the top drawer.

Common mistakes

I met them **at** the airport. (NOT I met them ~~on~~ the airport.)
There's a computer **on** my desk. (NOT There's a computer ~~in~~ my desk.)
The conference is being held **in** Delhi. (NOT The conference is being held ~~at~~ Delhi.)

B Where exactly?



I know they live **in** Danvers Street, and I think they're **at** number twenty-three.



I'm sure there's a chemist on the left **before** the bank. [first there is a chemist, and then a bank; *opp* **after**]



Their house is **beyond** the farm [on the other side of the farm], **by** [near] the old church.



I saw your bike in the back garden **against** the wall. [touching the wall]



They've just bought a house **right** [exactly] **beside/by** [next to] the river.



I found your phone on the sofa **beneath/underneath** a pile of cushions. [under]

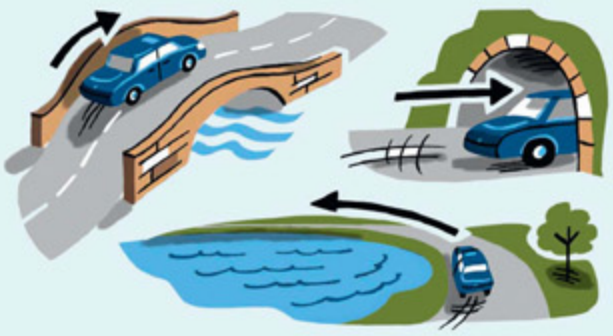


Their office is **above** the shop (*opp* **below**).



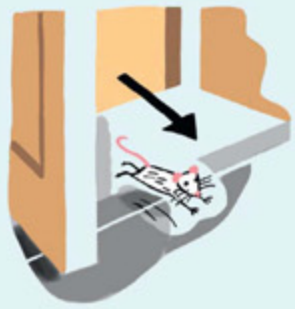
You can just see the top of the building **among** the trees. [somewhere in the middle of the trees]

C Movement



We came **over** the bridge (*opp* **under**), then **through** the tunnel and **round** the lake.

The mouse ran **out of** the back door (*opp* **into**), **towards** the gate, then disappeared **down** a hole.







The woman came **after** us [followed in order to catch us], but we managed to climb **into** the back of my dad's van. Fortunately she went **past** the van and didn't see us.

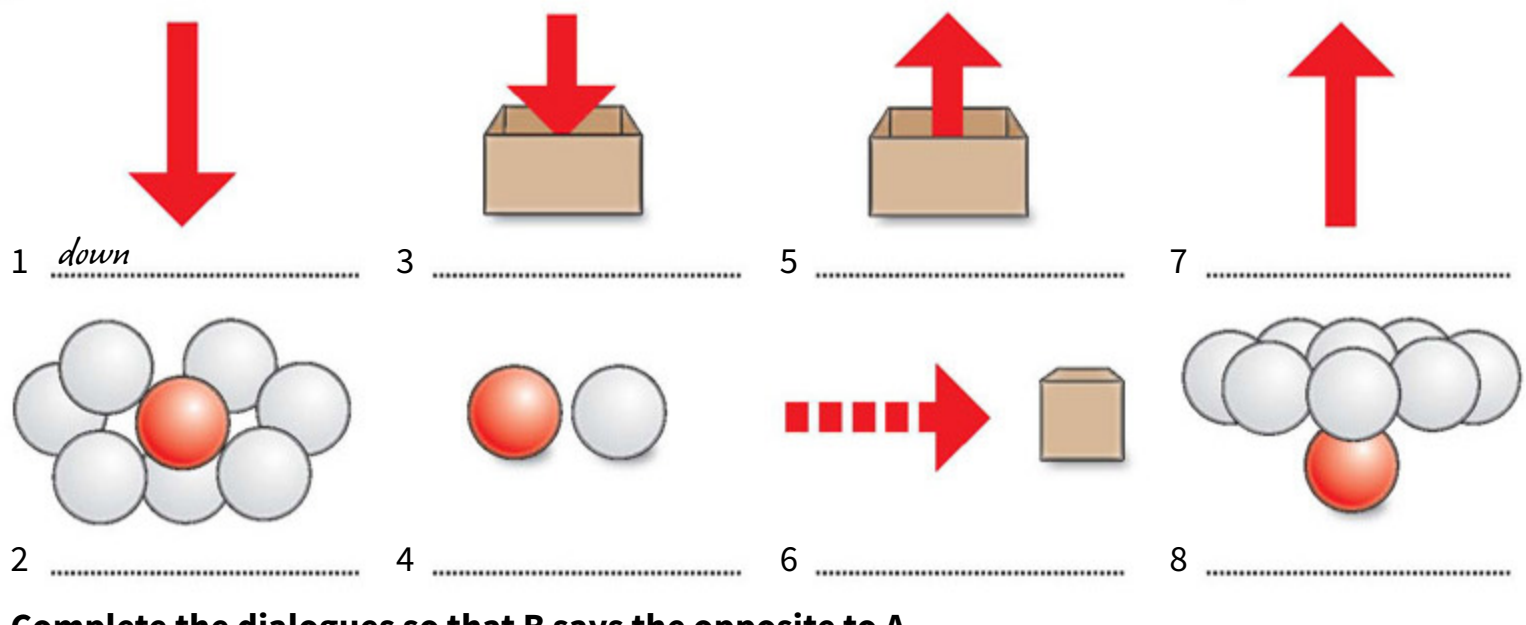
Exercises

90.1 Complete the sentences.

1 I put the milk *in* the fridge.
2 They live ..... the next road.
3 They live ..... 34 Lawrence Street.
4 Your clothes are ..... the floor.
5 I met her ..... a party.
6 She works ..... Moscow.
7 The dictionary is ..... my desk.
8 I sat ..... the bed and wrote the letter.
9 I left my books ..... school.
10 There was snow ..... the ground when I arrived.
11 The key is ..... my jacket pocket.
12 Mausha's ..... work this morning.

90.2 Put the prepositions in the box under the correct picture.

beside	towards	out of	~~down~~	among	into	up	underneath



1 *down* .....
3 .....
5 .....
7 .....
2 .....
4 .....
6 .....
8 .....

90.3 Complete the dialogues so that B says the opposite to A.

1 A: Did you go up the hill?
B: No, *down the hill.*
2 A: Did you climb over the fence?
B: No, we went .....
3 A: Did you see her get into the car?
B: No, but I saw her .....
4 A: Did you say we had to turn left before the bridge?
B: No, turn left .....
5 A: Does she live in the flat above you?
B: No, she's in the flat .....
6 A: Did you say the bed was in the middle of the room?
B: No, it's ..... the wall.

90.4 Over to you

Answer the questions, and give reasons for your answers. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

1 Is it a good idea to live right beside a hospital?

2 Would you like to live above a restaurant?

3 Are you happy to drive on icy roads?

4 Do you like putting lots of things on your bedroom wall?

5 In a plane or train, do you like sitting by the window?

6 Would you like to live among lots of rich and famous people?